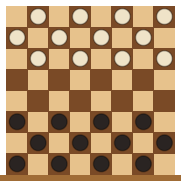
Checkers: How to Play



Checkers here follows **American / English draughts** for two players, plus one platform rule (below). You see your own pieces at the bottom of the board.

Setup and moving

- The board is 8 × 8 and play uses only the dark squares. Each player starts with 12 pieces. **Dark moves first.**
- A piece (a "man") moves one square diagonally **forward** to an empty square.
- A man that reaches the far row is **crowned** and becomes a king (shown with ♛). Kings move one square diagonally **forward or backward**.

Capturing

- Capture by jumping diagonally over an opposing piece next to yours onto the empty square beyond it. The jumped piece is removed. Men capture forward only; kings capture in any diagonal direction.
- **Capturing is compulsory.** When you can capture, only the pieces that can capture are highlighted. If several captures are possible you may choose **any** of them; you do not have to take the most pieces.
- After a capture, if the **same piece** can capture again, it must keep jumping. The piece stays selected and pulses until the sequence is over.
- **Crowning ends your turn**, even in the middle of a sequence of jumps.

Winning, resigning and draws

- You win when your opponent has no pieces left, or cannot make a legal move on their turn.
- You may **resign** at any time; your opponent wins.
- You may **offer a draw**. The game is drawn only if your opponent accepts. If they make a move instead of answering, the offer lapses.
- **Platform rule** (not part of the traditional rules): if the same position, with the same player to move, occurs for the third time, the game is drawn.

Making a move

Tap or click one of your highlighted pieces, then one of the highlighted squares (a ring marks a capture). With a keyboard, press Tab to reach the pieces and squares you can use, then Enter. Squares are named a1 to h8 from Dark's side.

Table option

Who plays Dark (moves first): the first seat (usually the host), or decided at random when the game starts.